



Saathi

साथी

Companion

Saathi helps families organise cancer care—from conversations and records to medicines, practical help and emotional support.



[OPEN THE WEBSITE](#)



github.com/basithladdu/healthathon



[Questions? Contact us](#)

wa.me/919553321211

By Zeros and Ones



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Technology



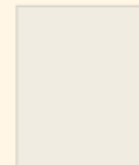
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When the care conversation gets lost



Mannar, Kerala · PIB photograph, 2011 · Not the story patient.

Imagine a 62-year-old woman with advanced breast cancer receiving best supportive care.



At the clinic

Her doctor discusses her wishes. Only her husband attends.



Two months later

She becomes unconscious and reaches hospital. The doctor asks what she would want if her heart stopped.



The family disagrees

Her husband says yes. Her daughter says no. Her son calls from another city. No one can find the earlier discussion.

A checked Care Note gives the family the same starting point.

Why families need support between visits

 **15.6 lakh**

Estimated new cancer cases in India in 2024.

[IARC, GLOBOCAN 2024](#)

 **98.39%**

Estimated unmet palliative-care need among people whose cancer had spread, across 10 cancer types.

[Patil et al., 2024](#)

 **88%**

Wanted to choose their treatment near the end of life in a 2019 survey of 2,400+ urban respondents.

[IndiaSpend reporting: seven cities](#)

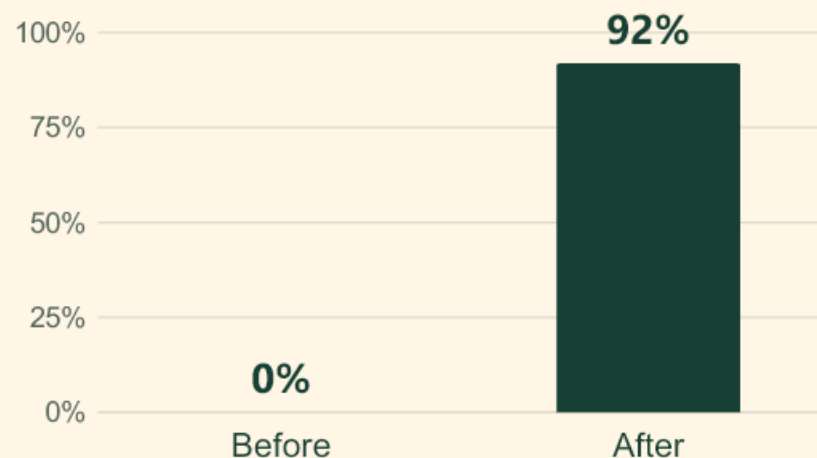
 **11.5%**

45 of 391 doctors at one hospital had training in advance directives, which record wishes for future care.

[Jacob et al., CMC Vellore, 2026](#)



One Chennai hospital improved documentation.



A standard process helped staff write down care discussions for 24 of 26 eligible patients.

Advanced pancreatic / colorectal cancer.

[Thangasamy et al., 2025](#)

Each study looked at a different group of people. These figures are not results from Saathi.

AI prepares the note. People check and sign it.

The doctor signs first. The patient then reviews and signs that version.

The screenshot displays the 'Saathi' web application interface. At the top, there's a header with the 'Saathi' logo, a language selector set to 'हिन्दी', and user controls for 'Doctor' and 'Sign out'. Below the header is a navigation bar with tabs: 'Overview', 'Record', 'Review & sign' (highlighted in yellow), 'History', and 'Find care'. The main content area is titled 'Review Care Note' for a patient named 'Meera Raghavan'. It features a progress bar with three steps: '1 Prepare draft', '2 Review & edit' (active), and '3 Sign Care Note'. A 'Note history' link is also present. The interface is split into two columns. The left column, 'Conversation source', shows a text box with a conversation summary: 'Meera met with me and her daughter Kavya today. She said it is important that her family understands what matters to her before we continue the discussion. She wants time to speak with them at home. We discussed who she wants involved and what questions she would like us to answer next. Specific treatment interventions were not discussed. We agreed to continue the conversation on 28 August.' The right column, 'Care Note draft', contains a 'Clinical review prompts' section, a 'Structured clinical form' input field, a 'What matters' section with a text box containing 'Meera wants time to speak with her family at home before continuing the discussion.', and a 'Who was there' section with a text box containing 'Meera met with me and her daughter Kavya today.'

Keep the source words and every signed version for the next conversation.

[Planned with Sarvam AI: Indian-language speech, translation and read-aloud.](#)

1. Record with permission.

Keep who said what in the conversation.

2. AI prepares a draft.

Separate agreed points from unanswered questions.

3. The doctor checks and signs.

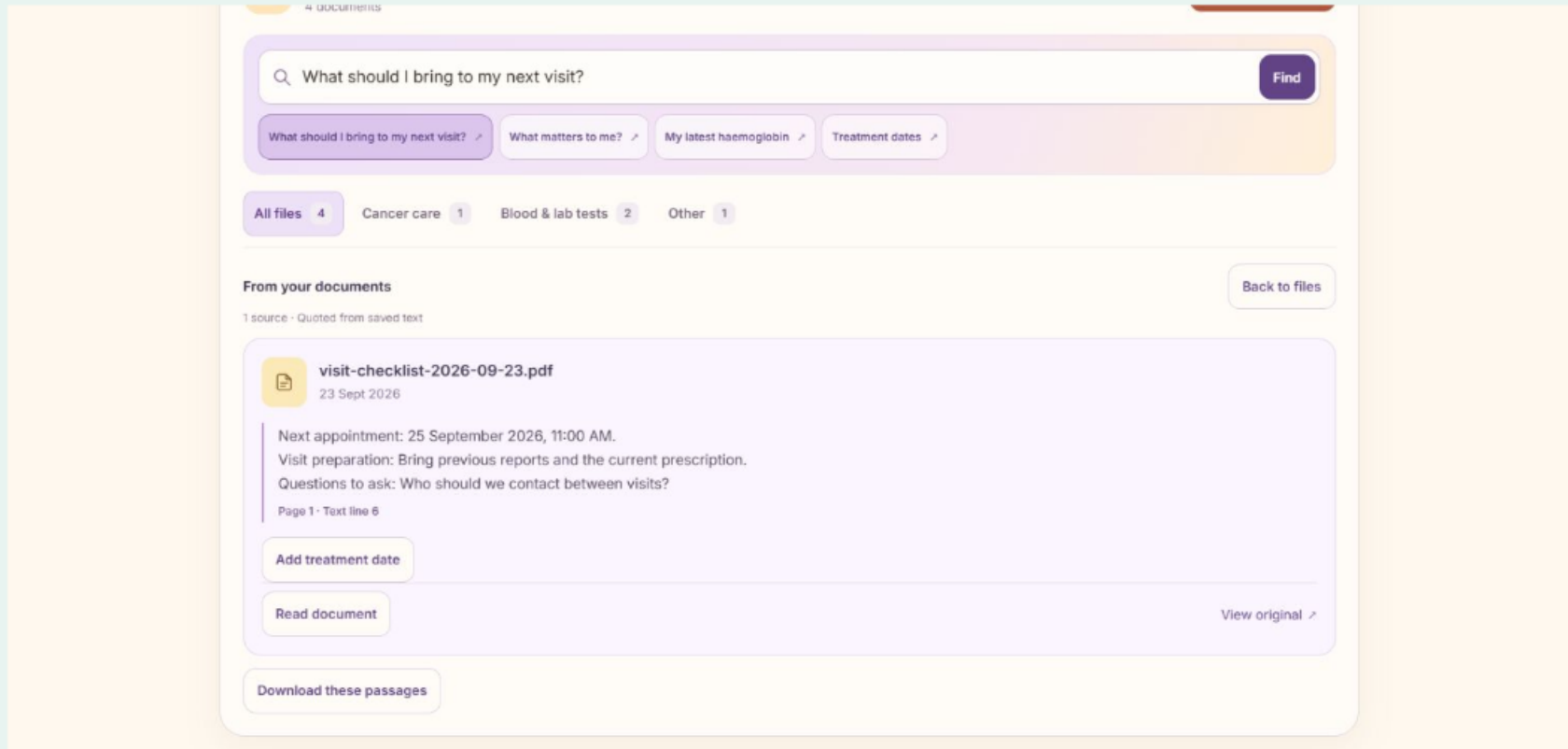
Correct the note and record clinical choices.

4. The patient signs that version.

Review the exact version. Keep earlier notes.

AI helps the family use its own records.

Ask about your own reports. See the original passage with the answer.



AI organises the records. The care team decides what treatment the patient needs.

Find an answer in a report

Ask a question. See the exact part of the report the answer came from. Say when it cannot be found.

See what happened when

Confirm that treatment happened and enter its date. Keep the quoted record beside it.

Add medicine reminders

Read the names and times from a printed prescription. Let a person check them before adding reminders.

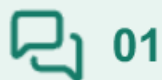
Care keeps moving when everyone knows their part.

Three sign-ins

Patient

Family

Doctor



01



02



03

Keep the conversation together.

The family opens the latest signed Care Note and keeps questions for the next visit.

Bring the right records.

Priya gathers reports and checks the quoted sources and confirmed treatment dates.

Plan medicines and visits.

Arjun checks reminders against the prescription and adds the next appointment.



04



05



06

Arrange help before leaving.

Priya arranges a ride. Arjun calls to confirm home-care support and prescribed medicine availability.

Keep costs and papers together.

Arjun keeps receipts, expenses and the paperwork needed to ask for financial help.

Make space for the caregiver.

Priya records what feels difficult. The family shares tasks and looks for emotional support.

[Find a centre → call to confirm → keep the contact and visit plan.](#)

Does Saathi help more care conversations happen?

We propose a 60–90 day study in a clinic, comparing care conversations before and after Saathi.

Patient requests

Count patients who ask for a conversation about their care and wishes. Record family requests separately.

Doctor-started discussions

Count conversations a doctor starts. Keep these separate from invitations that did not lead to a conversation.

Conversations written down

Count conversations with a saved Care Note. Record how many the doctor has checked and signed.

Before vs after

Patients whose care discussion was written down ÷ all patients who fit the study’s agreed rules

Also measure how long the work takes, what details were missed and whether doctors have more work.

The linked app shows the workflow. AI, verified sign-in and sharing between phones still need connecting.

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